

PREPARED DRAFT — NOT FOR SUBMISSION: the author reports that the same manuscript is currently under consideration at Journal of Neural Engineering. Formal PLOS ONE submission is blocked until that consideration has ended.

Dear Editors,

This prepared Research Article, “Source-only model selection and limits of fixed spectral-sharing pipelines in cross-subject motor-imagery EEG decoding”, examines how source-only training-duration selection, participant heterogeneity and frozen external evaluation constrain claims about calibration-free motor-imagery EEG decoding.

The study audits completed source-only development conditions and retains all participant-level and adverse or uncertain external results. Its contribution is an inspectable model-selection and evaluation evidence chain, rather than a new state-of-the-art domain-generalization algorithm. The separate BNCI sensor-level analysis is descriptive and does not attribute decoder mechanisms. The manuscript reports reproducible methods, uncertainty and limitations relevant to the technically sound, evidence-supported research considered by PLOS ONE.

Manuscript candidates, code and frozen results are publicly accessible on GitHub. The author reports no prior journal or preprint-platform publication. Original EEG remains accessible from the third-party providers; saved predictions, derived summaries and validation evidence are supplied or linked. AI assistance is disclosed in the Methods. Funding and competing-interest statements are provided separately for the submission system.

No PLOS ONE submission is being made with this draft. The exclusivity declaration, final approval of the PLOS-formatted files and any fee-assistance application must be completed by the author after the JNE status permits submission.

Sincerely,

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